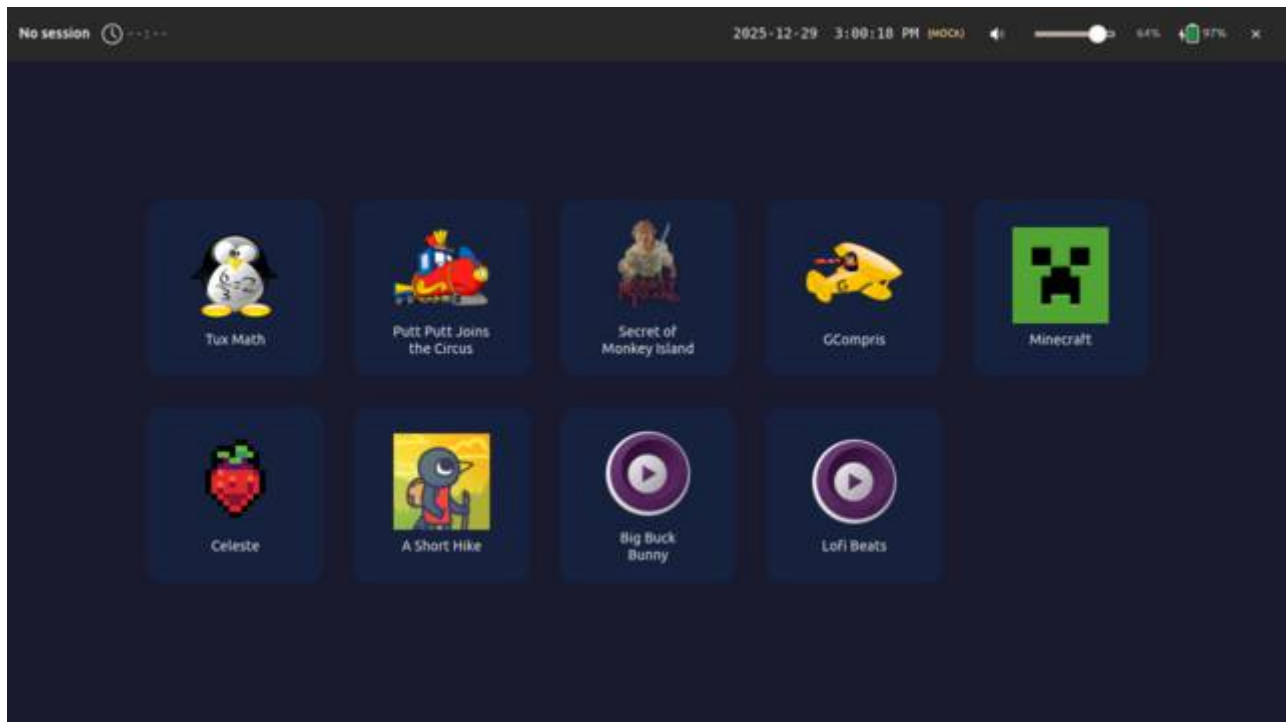


HTTP 451

This should have been the home page of shepherd-launcher -- a child-friendly, parent-guided desktop environment for Wayland that would have otherwise allowed supervised access to applications and content that you define.



By design, shepherd launcher **does not**:

- Replace parental involvement with automation or third-party content moderation
- Remotely monitor users with telemetry
- Collect, store, or report personally identifying information (PII)

Unfortunately, local laws in your region require operating system components, like shepherd-launcher, to perform some of the above functions to implement OS-level age verification.

As a result, we cannot distribute shepherd-launcher to you. If this message is visible to you at <https://git.armeafamily.com/albert/shepherd-launcher>, **your license to use shepherd-launcher is revoked**. You may not download, install, or redistribute it here or by any other means until the legislation impacting its use is amended or repealed.

Enacted incompatible legislation includes, but is not limited to:

- [California AB 1043](#), effective January 1, 2027
- [Brazil Lei 15.211](#), effective March 27, 2026

These and similar laws purport to protect children by limiting the content that is available to them, but their approach coerces ineffective automated moderation onto platforms, OS vendors, parents, and children. Such moderation inevitably lets harmful content through the cracks and cannot reflect every family's values.

Pending legislation in some other states would require government ID just to use a computer, which has wide-ranging privacy, online safety, and free expression implications for children and adults alike.

Instead of using automated moderation, shepherd-launcher relies on parents to define a whitelist of allowed content and the conditions under which it can be shown. shepherd-launcher uses this whitelist to manage process lifetime, a key operating system function. Ensuring safety in this way does not require any external service or age verification, so we will not implement it.

Unfortunately, the law in your area means that this safer alternative is not available to you.

If this concerns you, **please contact your representatives**.

Read more:

- [EFF resource hub on age verification and age gating](#)
- [System76's statement on age verification](#)
- [List of pending age verification legislation from The App Association](#)
- [Tom Scott on automated moderation](#)

If your project (unfortunately) needs geofenced Git hosting, you can clone this site's Docker Compose configuration [here](#) or [on GitHub](#).